

Week 10: Frameworks, Practice, and Scale

Navigating ideals and institutional realities in curriculum design

1. Instrumentalization Trap

Frameworks like TPACK and Backward Design start as descriptive tools to help us think but can quickly become prescriptive checklists that administrators use to evaluate teachers.

2. Paradise Gap

Duckworth, Perkins, and Wiggins describe beautiful visions that require conditions most schools lack: time, small groups, resources, and flexibility to follow student thinking.

3. Feedback as Through-Line

All readings emphasize timely, meaningful feedback throughout the learning process—whether from teachers, peers, or self-reflection—as central to understanding and growth.

4. Bricolage Over Blueprints

Teaching requires the improvisation and judgment of a bricoleur—making do with materials at hand—rather than following predetermined models or frameworks.

"Briefly, there is a tendency for open practices to be converted into instrumental practices."

— Hinchliffe, p. 41

This connects to rasquache and bricolage: when we try to make teaching "travel" everywhere, we strip away the contextual, improvisational work that actually makes it effective in particular places with particular students.

"Sometimes we spend so much time focusing on what's broken or not working that we forget to have our own wonderful ideas about what could be."